

When should young people be able to vote?

Imagine that you have attended an international youth conference in Scotland. Delegates from all over the world gathered to discuss aspects of being young, including the age at which young people are allowed to vote in local and general elections. You have been asked to contribute an article on this topic after the conference to the conference online forum.



"Here in Scotland, we can vote in Scottish Parliament elections when we are 16 years old. I think it's a good idea. I can legally get married and have children at the age of 16, and drive a car at 17, so why shouldn't I also be able to vote?" *Caitlin, 16*



"I come from the USA. We have to be 18 to vote in all political elections. I think that's OK. I can get my driver's license at 16, but I still think 16 is too young to understand important issues such as climate change and the environment."
Sam, 17



"I'm from Singapore and we can't vote until we are 21. I would like to vote at 16 on matters that directly affect young people. This could be education or the age when people can be punished for crimes. Here in Singapore, children can be held criminally responsible from the age of 10 years old. Then we could vote at 21 on broader topics when we have more knowledge."
Mei Ling, 17

Write an article* about voting age (500-600 words) for the after-conference online forum. You can use the above points of view as inspiration or make up your own.

- Describe briefly the conference that you attended.
- Describe some of the people you met and their points of view regarding young people's voting age.
- Explain your own thoughts, giving reasons for your opinion(s).
- Discuss why the topic of the voting age is relevant for young people to talk about.

*An article is a piece of writing on a particular subject in a newspaper, magazine or online for a large audience. The main aim of an article is to get it published and share your views with as many readers as possible.